(Prime Minister Crop Insurance Scheme). The ICAR-National Research Centre for Banana announcement has not been fulfilled. The UPA government had provided a 50 per cent discount on banana plantations. It has now been discontinued. Due to the unavailability of railway tracks, there are difficulties in transporting the produce.

Similarly, power-loom operators expressed their dilemmas. They spoke about the difficulty in obtaining a loan from the bank. Some regions offer concessions in electricity rates, while others do not. Previously, weavers were given a 30 per cent concession for technological improvements, but it has now been reduced to 10 per cent. The power-loom industry is placed under the category of small-scale industries. So they rightly felt they should receive the same facilities that entrepreneurs in that category were entitled to. After all, small power-loom workers can only compete with large entrepreneurs with State support. This discussion provided a deep insight into the lives of power-loom workers.

Long before the arrival of the journey in Madhya Pradesh, various social organizations, democratic groups and progressive writers held a meeting at Gandhi Bhawan in Bhopal. Thinkers, writers, artists and literary figures all participated. Yogendra Yadav organized the social organizations. Ekta Parishad participated in the entire yatra in Madhya Pradesh with P.V. Rajagopal ji. They walked in an organized manner, singing protest songs. Kabir Panthi and folk artists all joined in.

The Yatra continued to progress. It passed through the Khandwa and Khargone districts from Burhanpur. It seemed like we were reaching the Motli Mai region. The innocent folk society of Nimar refers to the Narmada river as Motli Mai. Unlike the rivers that originate from the Himalayas, the Narmada does not receive water from glaciers—it relies on rainfall. The jungle is its source. The Narmada is older than the Ganga and the Yamuna. Although it hosts fairs along its banks and people take baths in it, it is unique. The local community circumambulates the Narmada. This means taking a journey on foot from the origin to the final destination without crossing the river. Tribal communities predominantly inhabit the villages along the banks of the Narmada. Bhil, Bhilala, Gond, Baiga, Kol, Koraku